

UPSC GS-II POLITY

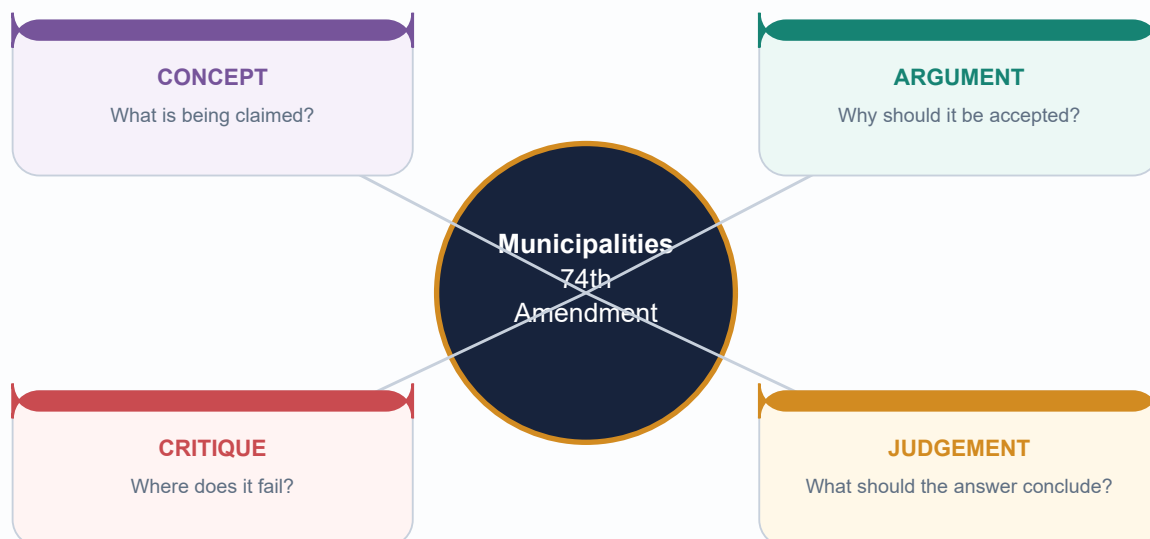
Municipalities -- 74th Amendment (Part IX-A)

Integrated Basic + Advanced Course

12 deep-learning modules | 74th Amendment to the Urban Finance Debate

Visual structures, planning committees, comparisons, UPSC traps and Mains frameworks

Prepared from the verified Polity knowledge base (Laxmikant, Ch. 39) and the completed guided session



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

74th Amendment Overview -- Part IX-A & Twelfth Schedule

GS-II Polity --
Constitutional
Amendments

NEWS TRIGGER

Every debate on urban local-body powers, elections and finance is anchored in the constitutional text inserted by the 74th Amendment, the urban counterpart of the 73rd Amendment for villages.

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 74th Amendment Act, 1992 added Part IX-A ('The Municipalities', Articles 243-P to 243-ZG) and the Twelfth Schedule (18 functional items, Article 243-W) to the Constitution, giving constitutional status to urban local bodies (ULBs).

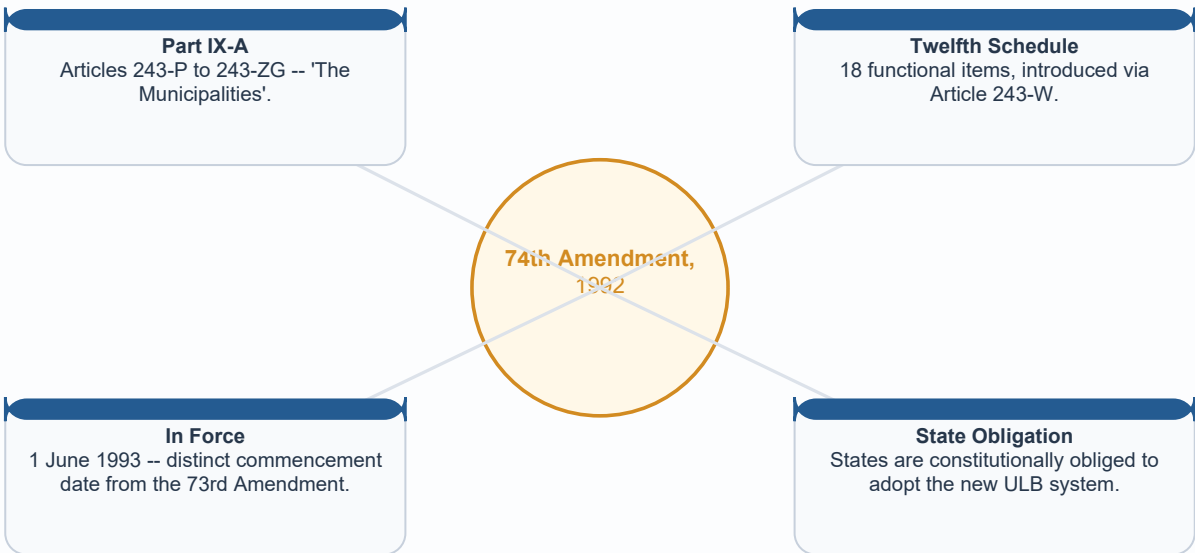
It came into force on 1 June 1993, and state governments are under a constitutional obligation to adopt this new system for their urban areas.

TIMELINE

1992 — 74th Amendment Act passed by Parliament.

1993 — Comes into force on 1 June; Part IX-A and Twelfth Schedule take effect.

ANATOMY OF THE 74TH AMENDMENT



KEY DATA

Item	Detail
Part / Articles	Part IX-A, Articles 243-P to 243-ZG
Schedule	Twelfth Schedule -- 18 subjects (Article 243-W)
Enacted / in force	74th Amendment 1992 -> in force 1 June 1993
Bodies covered	Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council, Municipal Corporation

STATIC THEORY

- The 74th Amendment mirrors the 73rd Amendment's design for rural areas, but with its own distinct commencement date and functional schedule.
- Unlike the 73rd Amendment's Article 40 (DPSP) origin, urban local self-government has no separate DPSP anchor -- it is a direct constitutional mandate for urban governance.
- The one-month gap in commencement dates (24 April 1993 for panchayats, 1 June 1993 for municipalities) is a frequently confused factual detail.

MEMORY HOOK

Part IX-A = urban structure; Twelfth Schedule = 18 subjects; in force 1 June 1993.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Part IX-A covers Articles 243-P to 243-ZG and is titled 'The Municipalities'.
2. The Twelfth Schedule lists 18 functional items under Article 243-W.
3. The 74th Amendment was passed in 1992 but came into force on 1 June 1993.
4. States are under a constitutional obligation to adopt the new municipal system.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The Twelfth Schedule has 29 items, like the Eleventh Schedule.

CORRECT: The Twelfth Schedule has 18 items; the Eleventh Schedule (for panchayats) has 29.

WRONG: The 74th Amendment came into force in 1992, the year it was passed.

CORRECT: It was passed in 1992 but came into force only on 1 June 1993.

MAINS ANGLE

Compare the constitutional design of the 74th Amendment with the 73rd Amendment, and examine whether urban local self-government has matched its rural counterpart in practice.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> Article 243-W -> Twelfth Schedule

HIGH

Three Types of Municipalities & the Industrial Township Exception

GS-II Polity --
Institutional
Structure

NEWS TRIGGER

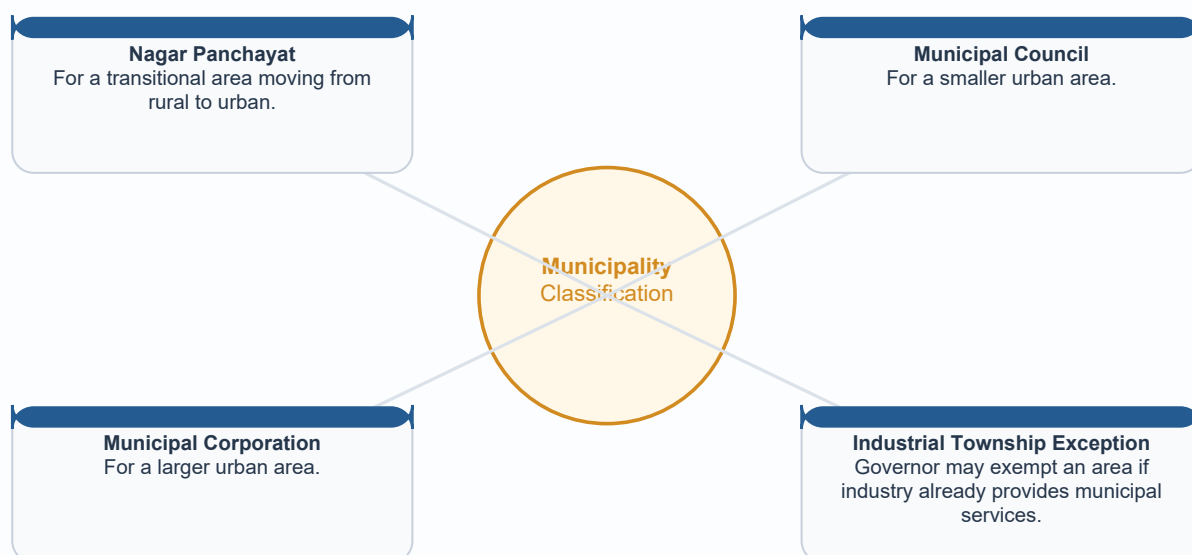
Classification disputes -- whether a fast-growing town should be a Nagar Panchayat or a full Municipal Council -- routinely surface in urban governance reforms.

INTRO & ORIGIN

The Constitution recognises three types of municipalities based on area size: the Nagar Panchayat for a transitional area (moving from rural to urban), the Municipal Council for a smaller urban area, and the Municipal Corporation for a larger urban area.

An exception exists for Industrial Townships: where an industrial establishment already provides municipal services, the Governor may specify the area and no municipality need be constituted at all. The Governor classifies areas using population, density, revenue, the percentage of employment in non-agricultural activities, and economic importance.

CLASSIFICATION OF MUNICIPAL BODIES



KEY DATA

Classification Criterion	Used By Governor To Decide
Population	Distinguishes transitional, smaller and larger urban areas
Density of population	Indicator of urbanisation level
Revenue generated for local administration	Fiscal viability of the proposed body
% employment in non-agricultural activities	Degree of urban economic character
Economic importance	Overall significance of the area

STATIC THEORY

- The three-body classification (Nagar Panchayat, Council, Corporation) is based on increasing area size and urbanisation, not on any fixed population number specified in the Constitution itself.
- The Industrial Township exception is significant because it allows the complete non-constitution of an elected municipal body where an industrial undertaking already renders equivalent services.
- This exception is a genuine constitutional carve-out, not merely an administrative convenience -- it directly affects the reach of elected urban local government.

MEMORY HOOK

Nagar-Council-Corporation = Transitional-Smaller-Larger (increasing size); Industrial Township = the one true exception.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Nagar Panchayat is for a transitional area moving from rural to urban.
2. Municipal Council is for a smaller urban area; Municipal Corporation for a larger one.
3. The Governor may exempt an Industrial Township from having a municipality at all.
4. The Governor classifies areas using population, density, revenue, non-agricultural employment and economic importance.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: A Nagar Panchayat is essentially a village panchayat under another name.

CORRECT: It is an urban body for a transitional area, distinct from rural panchayats under Part IX.

WRONG: Municipal Corporation is the smallest type of urban local body.

CORRECT: The Municipal Corporation is for the largest urban areas.

MAINS ANGLE

Examine the rationale for the Industrial Township exception under the 74th Amendment, and its implications for democratic urban local self-government.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> Classification of Municipalities

HIGH

Composition & Elections -- Wards and Wards Committees

GS-II Polity --
Elections &
Representation

NEWS TRIGGER

Delimitation of wards and the constitution of Wards Committees in large cities remain contentious ahead of most municipal election cycles.

INTRO & ORIGIN

All territorial seats in a municipality are directly elected from wards. Article 243-R additionally permits state legislatures to provide specified representation -- for persons with special knowledge or experience (without voting rights), and for specified MPs, MLAs and committee chairpersons.

Wards Committees, consisting of one or more wards, are mandatory in every municipality with a population of three lakh or more.

KEY DATA

Aspect	Provision
Territorial seats	Directly elected from wards
Additional representation (Art 243-R)	Persons with special knowledge (no vote); specified MPs/MLAs/committee chairpersons
Wards Committees	Mandatory where population is 3 lakh or more

FROM WARD DELIMITATION TO A FUNCTIONING MUNICIPALITY**STATIC THEORY**

- Direct election from wards is the uniform, compulsory democratic core of municipal composition, just as territorial seats are for panchayats.
- Article 243-R's provision for non-voting expert representation is a distinctive urban feature not paralleled in the panchayat structure.
- The 3-lakh population threshold for Wards Committees is a precise, frequently tested numerical detail.

MEMORY HOOK

Wards elect directly; Wards Committees only kick in at population 3 lakh or above.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. All territorial seats in a municipality are directly elected from wards.
2. Article 243-R permits additional, non-voting expert representation and specified MPs/MLAs.
3. Wards Committees are mandatory only where municipal population is 3 lakh or more.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Wards Committees are mandatory in every municipality regardless of size.

CORRECT: They are mandatory only where the population is 3 lakh or more.

MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the significance of Wards Committees in strengthening ward-level accountability in large urban local bodies.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> Elections -> Article 243-R

HIGH

Reservation, Duration and Disqualification

GS-II Polity --
Representation &
Institutional
Continuity

NEWS TRIGGER

Disputes over municipal dissolution and delayed elections routinely test the constitutional six-month deadline and the requirement of a hearing before dissolution.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Municipalities follow reservation rules for SC/ST by population and not less than one-third for women, with backward-class reservation left optional. Every municipality has a five-year term, with elections required within six months of dissolution.

Unlike panchayats, the municipal provisions specifically require a reasonable opportunity of hearing before a municipality is dissolved -- an added procedural safeguard. The minimum candidate age is 21, as with panchayats, lower than the 25 years required for state legislatures.

KEY DATA

Aspect	Provision
SC/ST reservation	In proportion to population
Women's reservation	Not less than 1/3 of seats
Backward class reservation	Optional (left to state legislature)
Term	5 years; election within 6 months of dissolution
Before dissolution	Reasonable opportunity of hearing required
Minimum candidate age	21 years (not 25, as for state legislatures)

STATIC THEORY

- The reasonable-opportunity-of-hearing requirement before dissolution is a specific procedural safeguard for municipalities, adding a layer of protection against arbitrary state action.
- Backward-class reservation being optional (unlike the compulsory SC/ST and women's reservation) mirrors the same compulsory-voluntary logic seen in the panchayat provisions.
- The minimum candidate age of 21 keeps municipal elections consistent with the panchayat threshold, both lower than the state legislature's 25.

MEMORY HOOK

SC/ST + women = compulsory reservation; backward classes = optional; age 21; hearing required before dissolution.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Women's reservation in municipalities is not less than one-third of seats.
2. Backward-class reservation in municipalities is optional for states.
3. A municipality must be given a reasonable opportunity of hearing before dissolution.
4. The minimum candidate age for municipal elections is 21 years.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The minimum candidate age for municipal elections is 25, as for state legislatures.

CORRECT: The minimum candidate age is 21.

MAINS ANGLE

Examine the procedural safeguards -- fixed term, six-month re-election deadline and the hearing requirement -- that protect municipalities from arbitrary dissolution.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> Reservation and Duration

HIGH**Planning Committees -- DPC vs MPC**

GS-II Polity --
Urban &
Regional
Planning

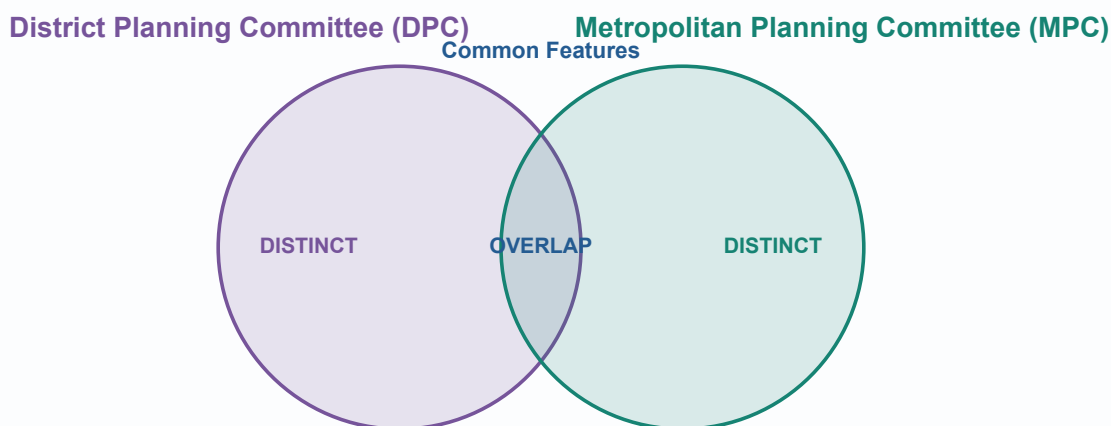
NEWS TRIGGER

Integrated planning across panchayats and municipalities in fast-growing metropolitan regions depends on these two constitutionally mandated planning committees.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Every district must have a District Planning Committee (DPC) to consolidate the development plans prepared by panchayats and municipalities in the district, with four-fifths of its members elected by elected members of the district panchayat and municipalities in a rural-urban population ratio.

Every metropolitan area must similarly have a Metropolitan Planning Committee (MPC), with two-thirds of its members elected by elected members of municipalities and panchayat chairpersons in that area, in proportion to their population.

DISTRICT PLANNING COMMITTEE VS METROPOLITAN PLANNING COMMITTEE**District Planning Committee (DPC)**

- Constituted for every district
- 4/5 of members elected, in rural:urban population ratio
- Consolidates panchayat + municipality plans district-wide

Common Features

- Prepares a draft development plan for the area
- Members drawn from elected local-body representatives

Metropolitan Planning Committee (MPC)

- Constituted for every metropolitan area
- 2/3 of members elected, in population ratio
- Focuses on integrated metropolitan-area planning

DPC = 4/5 elected (district-wide); MPC = 2/3 elected (metropolitan area) -- the fractions are a classic trap if swapped.

STATIC THEORY

- The DPC's mandate is district-wide, integrating both rural (panchayat) and urban (municipality) development plans.
- The MPC's mandate is specific to metropolitan areas, reflecting the distinct planning challenges of large urban agglomerations.
- The differing elected-member fractions (4/5 for DPC, 2/3 for MPC) are a precise, frequently swapped factual detail.

MEMORY HOOK

DPC = 4/5 elected (District); MPC = 2/3 elected (Metropolitan) -- D comes before M, 4/5 comes before 2/3.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The District Planning Committee (DPC) consolidates panchayat and municipality plans for the whole district.
2. Four-fifths of DPC members are elected in a rural-urban population ratio.
3. The Metropolitan Planning Committee (MPC) is constituted for every metropolitan area.
4. Two-thirds of MPC members are elected in proportion to population.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The DPC has two-thirds elected members, like the MPC.

CORRECT: The DPC has four-fifths (4/5) elected members; the MPC has two-thirds (2/3).

MAINS ANGLE

Evaluate whether District Planning Committees and Metropolitan Planning Committees have succeeded in integrating rural and urban development planning as envisaged.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> DPC and MPC -> Integrated Planning

HIGH**Municipal Finance Crisis & the 3 Fs Gap**

GS-II / GS-III
Polity -- Urban
Finance

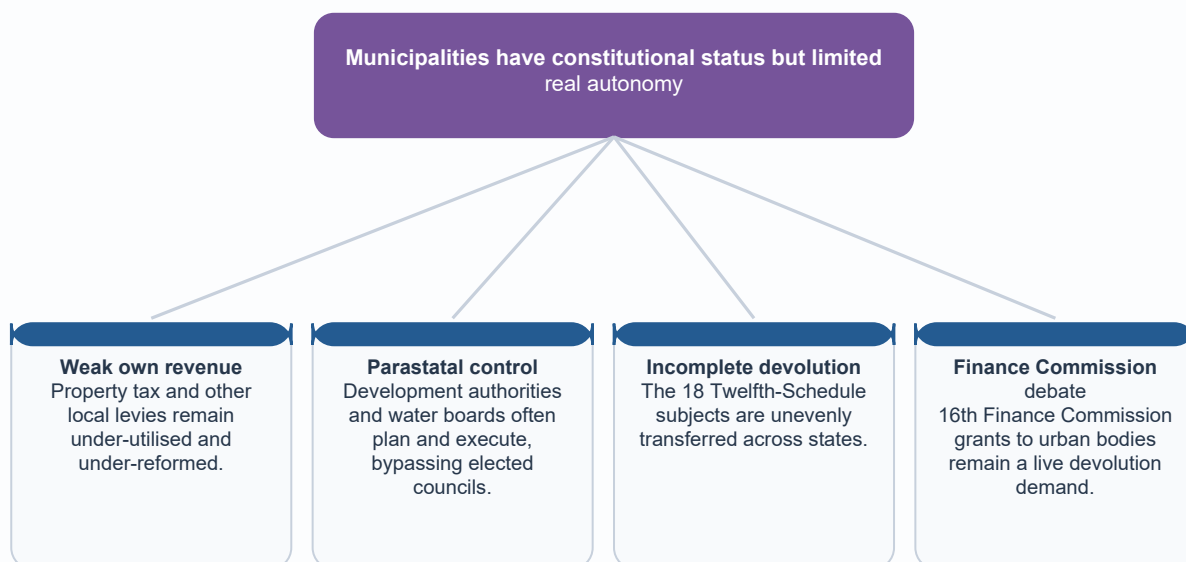
NEWS TRIGGER

ULBs' own revenue remains a tiny share of GDP; property-tax reform and 16th Finance Commission grants to urban bodies keep the urban finance debate alive.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Despite constitutional status, Indian cities face a persistent municipal finance crisis: weak own-revenue generation, incomplete devolution of the 18 Twelfth-Schedule subjects, and planning functions that often remain with parastatal agencies rather than elected municipalities.

WHY CITIES ARE 'GOVERNED BUT NOT SELF-GOVERNED'



STATIC THEORY

- The 'governed but not self-governed' critique captures the gap between constitutional recognition of ULBs and their actual planning and fiscal authority.
- Parastatals such as development authorities and water boards frequently perform functions that Article 243-W envisages for municipalities.
- Strengthening municipal finance requires action on multiple fronts: property-tax reform, municipal bonds, and enhanced Finance Commission devolution.

MEMORY HOOK

Cities are governed, not self-governed -- weak revenue + parastatal control + incomplete devolution.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. ULBs' own revenue is a small share of GDP compared to their expenditure needs.
2. Parastatal agencies often perform planning functions meant for elected municipalities.
3. 16th Finance Commission grants to urban bodies are a live current fiscal-devolution anchor.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Constitutional status under the 74th Amendment automatically secured strong municipal finances.

CORRECT: Constitutional status did not resolve weak own-revenue and incomplete devolution -- the municipal finance crisis persists.

MAINS ANGLE

'Indian cities are governed but not self-governed.' Examine in light of the 74th Amendment's unfulfilled promise, and discuss reforms such as property tax, municipal bonds and Finance Commission devolution.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> Municipal Finance -> 3 Fs Debate

HIGH

Comparison & Mains Synthesis -- 73rd vs 74th Amendment

GS-II Polity --
Comparative
Local
Government

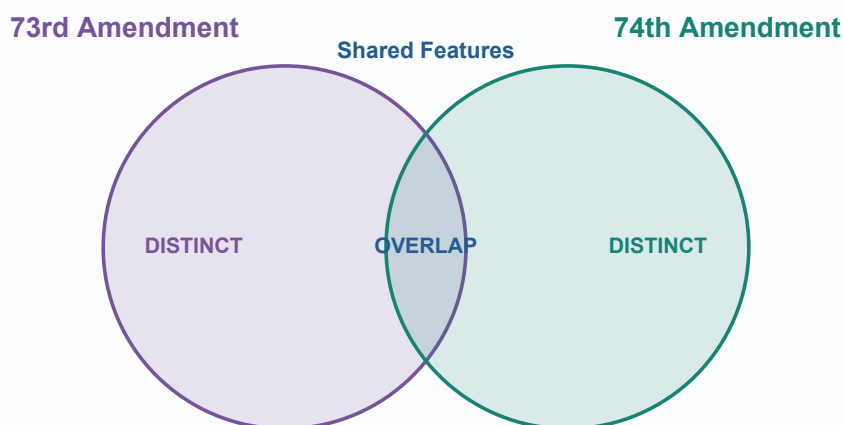
NEWS TRIGGER

Comparing the rural (73rd) and urban (74th) constitutional amendments is a recurring analytical demand, since both share common institutions but differ sharply in schedules, planning bodies and context.

INTRO & ORIGIN

The 73rd and 74th Amendments together constitutionalised local self-government in India -- one for villages, one for towns and cities -- sharing common institutional machinery but differing in scope and detail.

73RD AMENDMENT (PANCHAYATS) VS 74TH AMENDMENT (MUNICIPALITIES)



73rd Amendment

- Part IX, Eleventh Schedule (29 subjects)
- In force 24 April 1993
- Rural focus; 3-tier structure with Gram Sabha

Shared Features

- Direct election of territorial seats
- SC/ST and women's ($\geq 1/3$) reservation
- 5-year term; State Election Commission; State Finance Commission
- Minimum candidate age 21

74th Amendment

- Part IX-A, Twelfth Schedule (18 subjects)
- In force 1 June 1993
- Urban focus; DPC/MPC planning committees

Both Amendments share the same democratic core -- direct election, reservation, tenure and shared SEC/SFC machinery -- but differ in schedules, timing and planning bodies.

STATIC THEORY

- Recognising the shared institutional core (SEC, SFC, reservation, tenure, age 21) alongside the distinct schedules and commencement dates is essential for accurate comparative answers.
- The municipal system additionally introduces DPC and MPC planning committees, which have no direct panchayat-only equivalent since they integrate both rural and urban plans.
- Both systems share the same fundamental critique: political decentralisation has outpaced administrative and fiscal decentralisation.

MEMORY HOOK

73rd = rural, 11th Schedule (29), 24 April 1993; 74th = urban, 12th Schedule (18), 1 June 1993 -- shared SEC/SFC/age-21 core.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The 73rd Amendment applies to panchayats; the 74th Amendment applies to municipalities.
2. Both share direct election, reservation, 5-year tenure and common SEC/SFC machinery.
3. The 74th Amendment additionally introduces DPC and MPC planning committees.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The 73rd and 74th Amendments came into force on the same date.

CORRECT: The 73rd Amendment came into force on 24 April 1993; the 74th on 1 June 1993 -- different dates.

MAINS ANGLE

Compare and contrast the 73rd and 74th Amendments, and examine whether urban local self-government (municipalities) has achieved the same institutional depth as rural local self-government (panchayats).

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX vs Part IX-A -> Comparative Local Government

MEDIUM UPSC RELEVANCE**MEDIUM****State Election Commission & State Finance Commission**

GS-II Polity --
Shared
Local-Body
Institutions

NEWS TRIGGER

The same institutional machinery that conducts panchayat elections and reviews panchayat finances also governs municipalities -- a frequently tested point of institutional overlap.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Municipal elections, like panchayat elections, are conducted by the State Election Commission. Municipal finances are reviewed by the same State Finance Commission that reviews panchayat finances, once every five years.

STATIC THEORY

- Using one State Election Commission for both panchayats and municipalities avoids duplicating independent electoral machinery at the state level.
- The single State Finance Commission mechanism ensures a common, coordinated approach to distributing state resources among all tiers of local government.
- This institutional sharing is a design efficiency, not evidence that panchayats and municipalities are governed by identical substantive rules -- their structures still differ (e.g. schedules, tiers, planning committees).

MEMORY HOOK

One SEC, one SFC -- shared across both panchayats and municipalities.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The State Election Commission conducts both panchayat and municipal elections.
2. The same State Finance Commission reviews both panchayat and municipal finances.
3. The SFC is constituted by the Governor once every five years.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Municipalities have a separate Election Commission from panchayats.

CORRECT: The same State Election Commission conducts elections for both panchayats and municipalities.

SHARED INSTITUTIONS ACROSS LOCAL GOVERNMENT

Function	Institution	Why It Matters
Conducting municipal elections	State Election Commission	Same body that conducts panchayat elections -- a single, independent electoral machinery for all local bodies
Reviewing municipal finances	State Finance Commission	Same SFC (constituted by the Governor every 5 years) reviews both panchayat and municipal finances

MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the significance of a common State Election Commission and State Finance Commission across both rural and urban local bodies.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> State Election

Commission -> State Finance Commission

MEDIUM**Exempted Areas**

GS-II Polity --
Special Areas

NEWS TRIGGER

As with panchayats, the standard municipal framework does not reach every part of the country -- a fact often missed in comparative urban-governance questions.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Part IX-A does not apply to Fifth and Sixth Schedule (scheduled and tribal) areas, and it does not affect the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council.

KEY DATA

Excluded Area	Note
Fifth Schedule areas	Tribal areas outside the standard municipal framework
Sixth Schedule areas	Tribal areas of the north-east with autonomous district councils
Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council	Not affected by Part IX-A's municipal provisions

STATIC THEORY

- This exemption pattern for municipalities parallels the panchayat exemptions -- both Part IX and Part IX-A stop short of Fifth/Sixth Schedule areas.
- The Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council exemption is specific and frequently paired in exam questions with the equivalent panchayat exemption.

MEMORY HOOK

Municipalities excluded exactly where panchayats are: Fifth/Sixth Schedule + Darjeeling GHC.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Part IX-A does not apply to Fifth and Sixth Schedule areas.
2. It does not affect the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Part IX-A applies uniformly across the entire country including tribal areas.

CORRECT: It excludes Fifth and Sixth Schedule areas and does not affect the Darjeeling Gorkha Hill Council.

MAINS ANGLE

Compare the exempted areas under Part IX-A (municipalities) with those under Part IX (panchayats), and examine the constitutional logic behind these exclusions.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> Exempted Areas

MEDIUM**Twelfth Schedule -- 18 Functional Items**

GS-II Polity --
Functional
Devolution

NEWS TRIGGER

The gap between the 18 subjects listed for devolution and the functions municipalities actually exercise is central to the urban governance-reform debate.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Article 243-W empowers state legislatures to endow municipalities with powers over the 18 functional items listed in the Twelfth Schedule, enabling them to function as institutions of urban self-government.

FUNCTIONAL SUBJECTS BY SCHEDULE -- PANCHAYATS VS MUNICIPALITIES

Eleventh Schedule (Panchayats)

29

Twelfth Schedule (Municipalities)

18

Constitutional count of functional items assigned to each local-body schedule.

STATIC THEORY

- Like the Eleventh Schedule for panchayats, devolution of the Twelfth Schedule's 18 items to municipalities is a matter for state legislatures, not an automatic constitutional transfer.
- The Twelfth Schedule's smaller count (18) compared to the Eleventh Schedule (29) reflects the more concentrated, urban-specific nature of municipal functions such as urban planning, water supply and solid waste management.
- Uneven devolution of these 18 items across states is a direct driver of the '3 Fs' gap discussed in the urban finance module.

MEMORY HOOK

Twelfth Schedule = 18 for municipalities; Eleventh Schedule = 29 for panchayats -- never swap the two.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. The Twelfth Schedule lists 18 functional items for municipalities under Article 243-W.
2. Devolution of these items to municipalities is left to state legislatures.
3. The Eleventh Schedule (panchayats) lists 29 items -- a frequently confused comparison.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The Twelfth Schedule has 29 items, confusing it with the Eleventh Schedule.

CORRECT: The Twelfth Schedule has 18 items; the Eleventh Schedule (panchayats) has 29.

MAINS ANGLE

Examine why devolution of the Twelfth Schedule's 18 functional items to municipalities remains incomplete, and its consequences for urban governance.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> Article 243-W -> Twelfth Schedule

MEDIUM**Eight Types of Urban Local Bodies**

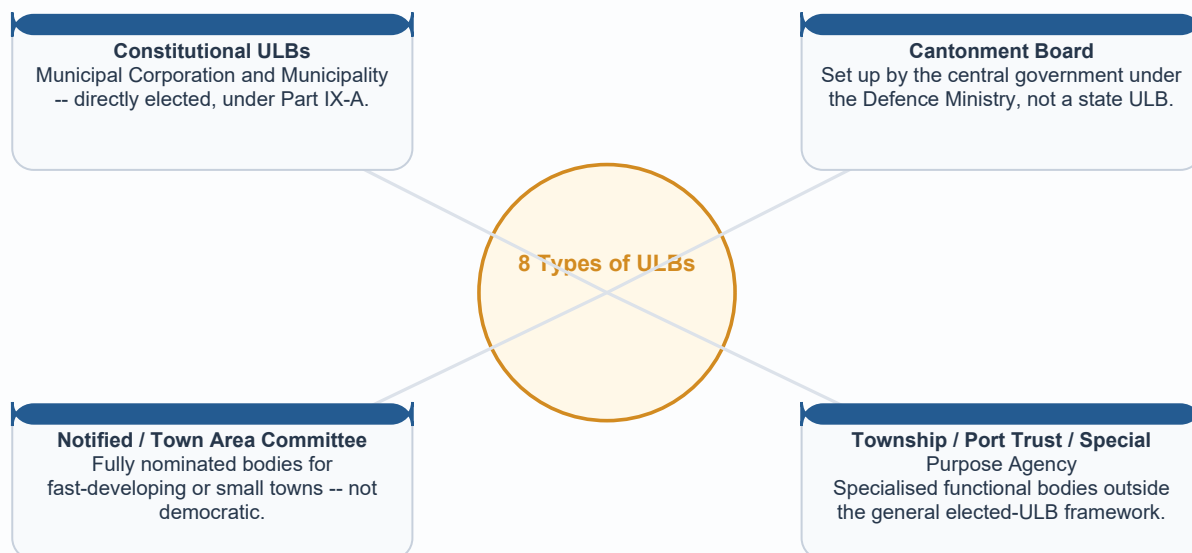
GS-II Polity --
Urban
Administration

NEWS TRIGGER

Beyond the three constitutional municipal bodies, India's urban administration includes several non-constitutional bodies -- notably the centrally controlled Cantonment Board -- that are frequently confused with elected ULBs.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Beyond the constitutional three (Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council, Municipal Corporation), India recognises eight types of urban administration in total: Municipal Corporation, Municipality, Notified Area Committee, Town Area Committee, Cantonment Board, Township, Port Trust, and Special Purpose Agency.

THE EIGHT TYPES OF URBAN LOCAL BODIES

STATIC THEORY

- The Cantonment Board is established under the Cantonments Act by the central government's Defence Ministry -- it is not a state-created or elected municipal body.
- The Notified Area Committee is used for a fast-developing town, or a town not yet fulfilling the conditions for a municipality; it is fully nominated and hence not a democratic body.
- Special Purpose Agencies (such as development authorities or water boards) increasingly perform functions that would otherwise belong to elected municipalities -- a core theme in the urban-finance and devolution debate.

MEMORY HOOK

3 constitutional ULBs + Cantonment Board (Centre) + Notified/Town Area Committee (nominated) + Township/Port Trust/SPA = 8 types.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. India recognises eight types of urban local bodies in total.
2. The Cantonment Board is set up by the central government under the Defence Ministry.
3. The Notified Area Committee is fully nominated, not democratically elected.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: The Cantonment Board is a state-level urban local body.

CORRECT: It is set up by the Centre (Defence Ministry), not by a state government.

MAINS ANGLE

Discuss the democratic deficit created by non-elected urban bodies such as the Cantonment Board and Notified Area Committees within India's urban governance system.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Urban Administration -> Eight Types of ULBs

MEDIUM

CA -- AMRUT, Smart Cities and Elected ULBs

GS-II / GS-III
Polity -- Current
Affairs
Integration

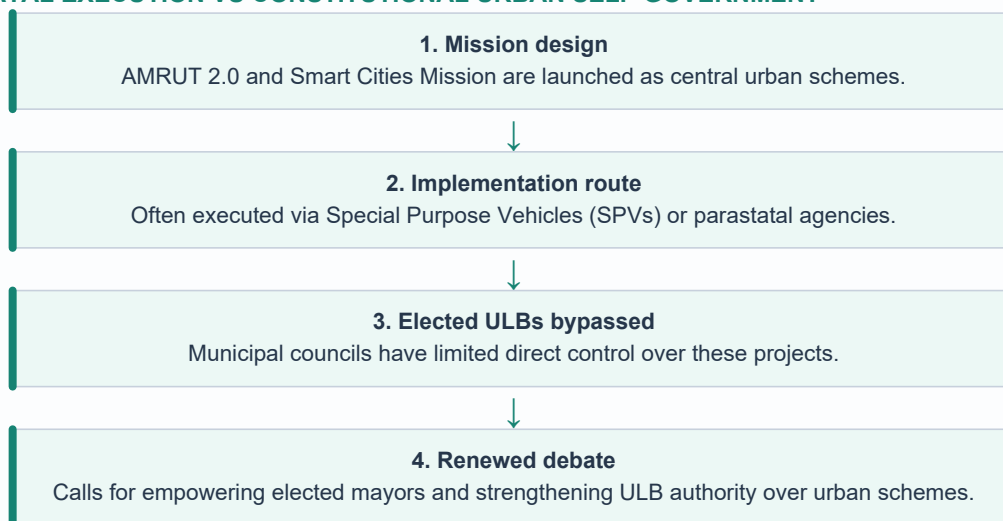
NEWS TRIGGER

AMRUT 2.0 and the Smart Cities Mission are frequently implemented through special purpose vehicles rather than elected municipal councils, renewing debate on directly elected mayors and the constitutional role of ULBs.

INTRO & ORIGIN

Major urban renewal programmes such as AMRUT (Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation) and the Smart Cities Mission often run partly through parastatal structures rather than through the elected ULBs envisaged by the 74th Amendment.

PARASTATAL EXECUTION VS CONSTITUTIONAL URBAN SELF-GOVERNMENT



STATIC THEORY

- This CA pattern directly illustrates the '3 Fs' and 'governed but not self-governed' themes discussed elsewhere in this course, applied to specific flagship urban missions.
- The directly-elected-mayor debate proposes strengthening municipal executive authority as one institutional response to parastatal dominance.

MEMORY HOOK

AMRUT + Smart Cities via SPVs = mission efficiency at the cost of elected ULB authority.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. AMRUT 2.0 and the Smart Cities Mission are often implemented via Special Purpose Vehicles or parastatals.
2. This implementation route bypasses direct control by elected municipal councils.
3. It has renewed debate on directly-elected mayors and stronger constitutional ULB authority.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: AMRUT and Smart Cities Mission projects are always implemented directly by elected municipal councils.

CORRECT: They are frequently implemented through parastatal Special Purpose Vehicles instead.

MAINS ANGLE

Examine the tension between mission-mode urban schemes like AMRUT 2.0 and Smart Cities, implemented via parastatals, and the constitutional vision of elected municipal self-government under the 74th Amendment.

STUDY LINK

Polity -> Part IX-A -> AMRUT / Smart Cities -> Elected Mayor Debate